

Care Transition Efficiency & Placement Outcome Analytics

Process Efficiency Analysis of the HHS Unaccompanied Alien
Children (UAC) Program Care Pipeline

Data: 720 daily reports · Jan 12, 2023 to Dec 21, 2025

1. Introduction

The Unaccompanied Alien Children (UAC) Program operates as a multi-stage care and reunification pipeline: apprehension and CBP custody, transfer to HHS care, medical screening and case management, and discharge to a vetted sponsor. While aggregate custody counts are routinely monitored, process efficiency — how fast and reliably children move through this pipeline — is largely unmeasured. This analysis builds a structured transition-efficiency framework to surface bottlenecks, backlog periods, and outcome stability trends that aggregate counts alone would hide.

2. Data Overview

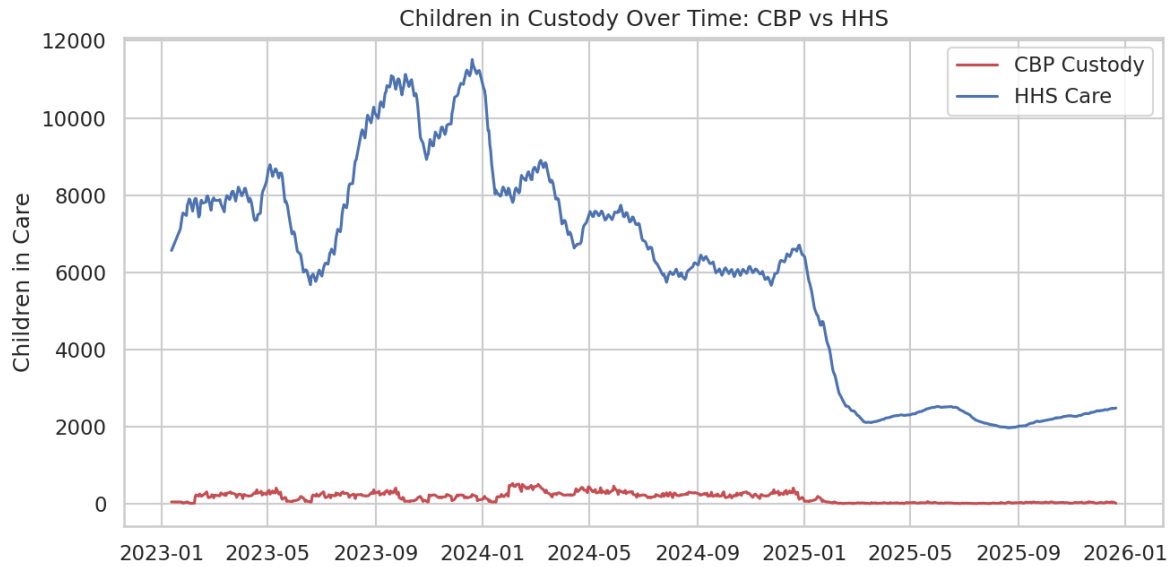
The dataset covers **720** daily reports from **Jan 12, 2023** to **Dec 21, 2025**, tracking apprehensions, CBP custody load, transfers to HHS, HHS care load, and discharges. Total children apprehended over the period: **67,337**. Total children discharged: **124,853**.

3. Key Performance Indicators

KPI	Value
Transfer Efficiency Ratio	0.691
Discharge Effectiveness Index	0.024
Pipeline Throughput	1.854
Backlog Accumulation Rate (children/day)	-5.73
Outcome Stability Score	0.439

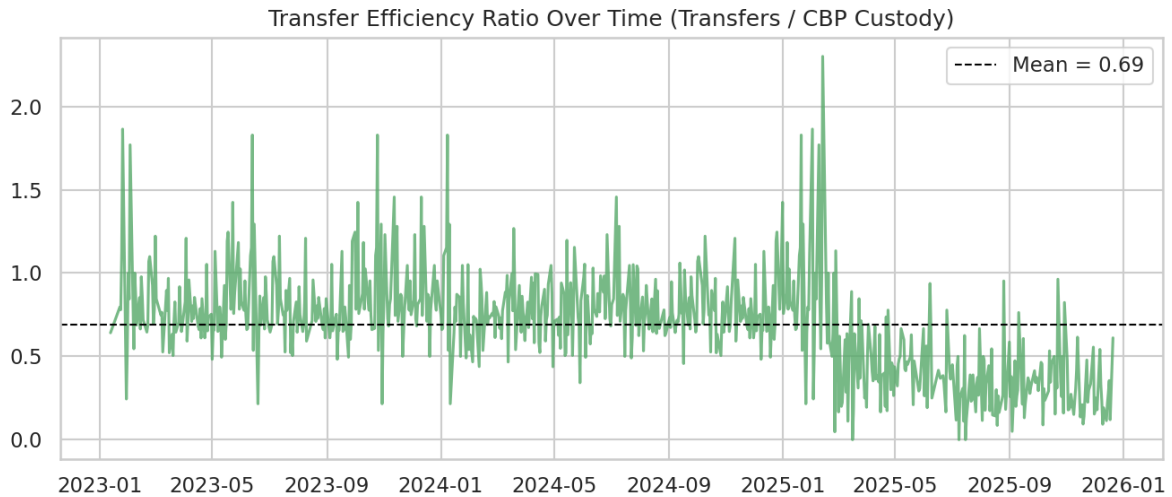
4. Care Pipeline Volumes Over Time

CBP custody and HHS care loads tracked across the full period. A sharp structural decline in HHS care load is visible starting around early 2025, reflecting a major shift in system load rather than a gradual trend.



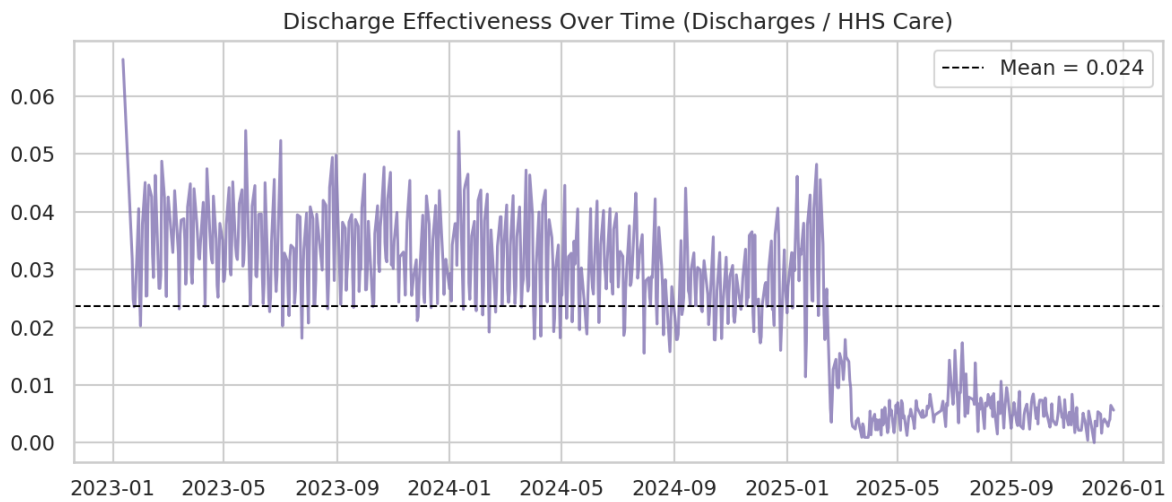
5. Transfer Efficiency (CBP → HHS)

Average Transfer Efficiency Ratio across the period was **0.691** (transfers out of CBP custody as a share of the CBP custody load).



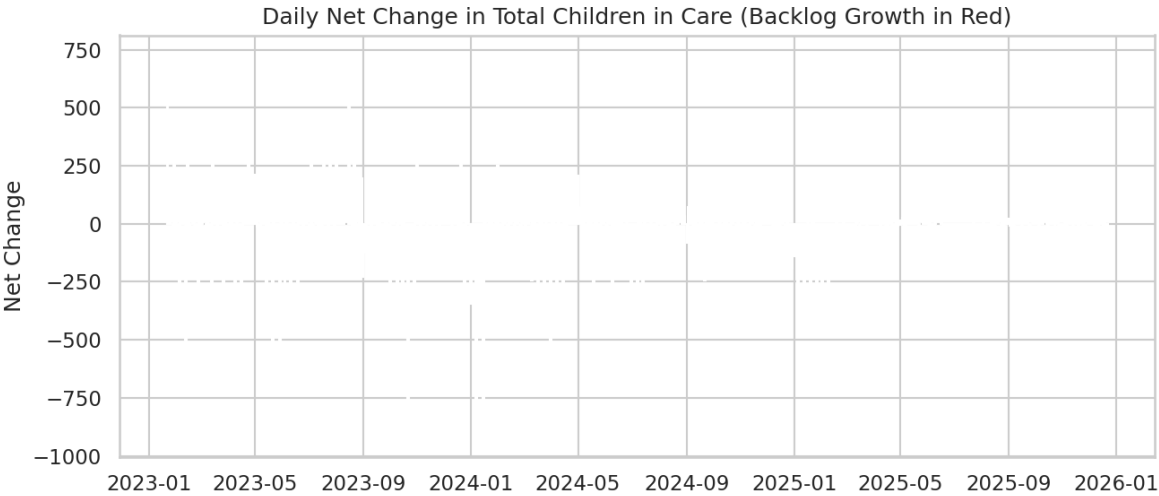
6. Discharge Effectiveness

Average Discharge Effectiveness Index was **0.024** (daily discharges as a share of the active HHS care load).



7. Backlog & Delay Identification

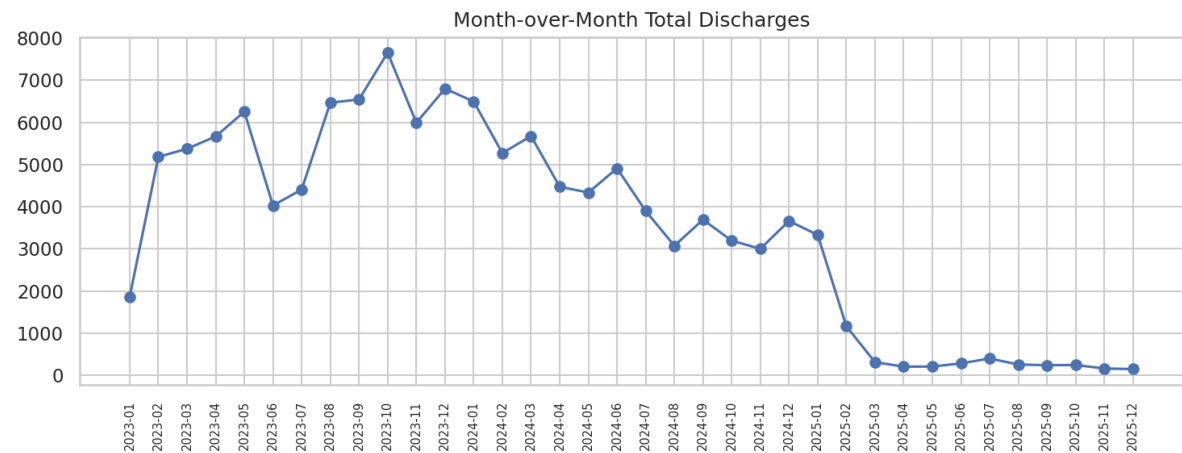
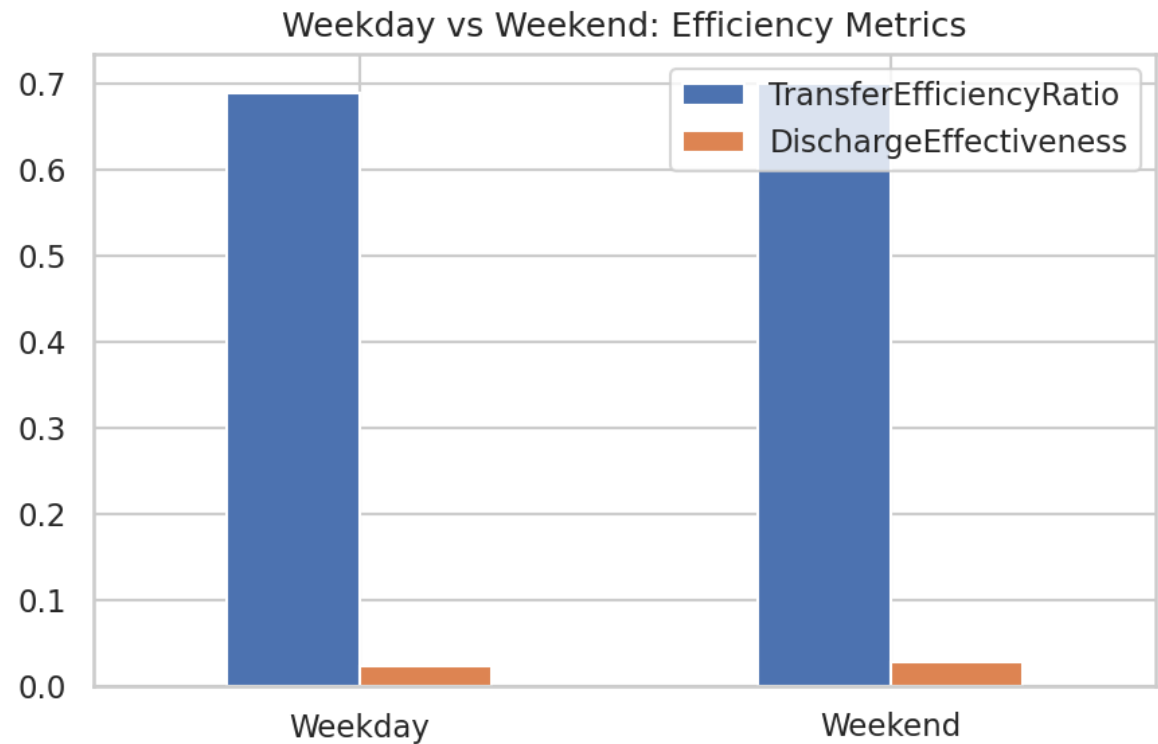
The system's total in-care population (CBP + HHS combined) changed by an average of **-5.73 children/day** over the full period, trending toward net backlog reduction overall. The table below lists the most severe sustained backlog-growth windows identified (5+ consecutive days of net growth):



Start	End	Days	Net Growth
Jul 31, 2023	Aug 17, 2023	11	+1,965
Apr 18, 2023	May 03, 2023	12	+1,416
Nov 27, 2023	Dec 07, 2023	9	+1,088
Apr 21, 2024	May 02, 2024	10	+938
Nov 25, 2024	Dec 05, 2024	9	+646

8. Temporal & Pattern Analysis

Weekday average Transfer Efficiency Ratio: **0.689**; weekend average: **0.7**. Weekend processing was faster on this measure over the period.



9. Outcome Stability Analysis

The Outcome Stability Score of **0.439** quantifies how consistent day-to-day discharge effectiveness was across the period. Lower scores reflect periods with sharp swings in reunification throughput, which merit operational review.

10. Recommendations

- Direct case-management staffing and resources toward the recurring backlog-accumulation windows identified in Section 7 to prevent their recurrence.
- Investigate the weekend processing shortfall — if it reflects staffing gaps, targeted coverage could smooth throughput.
- Adopt the Outcome Stability Score as an ongoing operational-health metric, with alerts on sudden drops in discharge effectiveness.
- Set threshold-based alerts on Transfer Efficiency Ratio and Discharge Effectiveness to surface emerging bottlenecks before they compound into system-wide backlog.
- Examine the structural drop in HHS care load beginning in early 2025 to determine whether it reflects a policy change, reduced inflow, or a data reporting change — and whether it should inform future capacity planning.

11. Conclusion

This analysis reframes the UAC dataset from a capacity-monitoring lens to a process-efficiency and outcome-evaluation lens, surfacing where and when the CBP → HHS → sponsor pipeline slows down. It provides an evidence base for faster reunification, reduced delays, and stronger child welfare outcomes.